Mehfil-e-Zan

Gather. Grow. Glow.

GENERAL OFFICE STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURES

Workplace rules, employee conduct and daily office procedures

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Status	Draft for approval
Applies to	All employees, trainees and interns of Mehfil-e-Zan

Student project note: *This document is a student project deliverable. Leave entitlements, working hours and other figures are business assumptions. They must be checked against the labour and employment laws that apply in Sindh and Pakistan, and reviewed by a qualified adviser, before a real business adopts them.*

1. Purpose and Scope

1.1 Purpose

This SOP sets out the rules, behaviour standards and daily procedures that every member of Mehfil-e-Zan follows at work. It aims to give everyone the same clear expectations, protect the privacy and comfort of our guests, and keep the cafe running smoothly and fairly.

1.2 Scope

This SOP applies to all permanent, part-time, contract and probationary employees, trainees and interns, at the Gulshan-e-Iqbal cafe and during off-site events run in the name of Mehfil-e-Zan. Specialised topics are covered in separate documents and are referred to here where needed.

1.3 Business assumptions

- Mehfil-e-Zan is a women-only cafe and community space. Staff and guests are women. Male delivery riders, vendors and technicians use the separate entrance and waiting area described in the Security SOP.
- The cafe opens daily from 10:00 AM to 10:00 PM and seats up to 40 guests.
- Eleven core team members manage the business. Frontline staff (baristas, kitchen and floor team) are hired as needed and report through the Supervisor.
- The women-only staffing and customer policy must be verified for legal compliance in the cafe's jurisdiction before adoption.

1.4 Related documents

Document ID	Title	Where it applies
MEZ-POL-001	IT Rules and Regulations Policy	Computers, email, passwords
MEZ-SOP-002	Security Measures SOP	Entry, visitors, emergencies
MEZ-SOP-003	Professional Communication Ethics SOP	Internal communication
MEZ-POL-002	HR and Employee Management Policy	Hiring, appraisal, grievances
MEZ-FRM-001 to 003	Attendance Register, Leave Request Form, Visitor Register	Forms used in this SOP

Note: *Document IDs follow the scheme MEZ-[type]-[number], where type is SOP, POL or FRM. They will be listed in the Master Document Register (MEZ-REG-001).*

2. Roles and Responsibilities

Every team member must follow this SOP. The roles below carry extra responsibilities for running it.

Role	Responsibilities under this SOP
Owner	Gives final approval to this SOP and to major changes. Hears final appeals in disciplinary cases.
CEO	Enforces the SOP across all departments, approves senior leave and decides serious disciplinary cases together with the HR Manager.

Role	Responsibilities under this SOP
HR / Sales / Marketing Manager	Manages attendance and leave records, advises on conduct issues, runs the disciplinary process and receives grievances.
Finance Director	Checks leave and overtime data that affect payroll, and keeps office equipment and asset costs under control.
Sales Executive and Marketing Executive	Follow all rules in this SOP. Report to the HR / Sales / Marketing Manager and request leave through that line.
Supervisor	Supervises the daily shift, marks attendance, checks dress code and cleanliness, runs the shift briefing and approves short leave.
Operations Officer	Plans shifts and rosters, checks that equipment and shared spaces are in working order, and approves overtime and shift swaps.
IT Manager	Looks after office computers, POS, WiFi and the attendance system, and assigns equipment to staff.
Security Manager	Ensures staff follow entry, safety and emergency rules, and handles conduct incidents that involve security.
Documentation & Compliance Coordinator	Owns this document, keeps version control and the review schedule, records staff acknowledgement and tracks compliance.
All employees	Follow this SOP, arrive on time, treat others with respect, protect guest privacy, look after equipment and report problems promptly.

3. Office Timings, Attendance and Leave

3.1 Opening hours and shifts

The cafe is open to guests from 10:00 AM to 10:00 PM, seven days a week. Staff work in two shifts so that preparation before opening and cleaning after closing are covered.

Shift	Timing	Break	Main duties
Morning shift	9:00 AM to 5:30 PM	30 minutes, plus 15 minutes of rest	Opening checks, food preparation, lunch service
Evening shift	2:30 PM to 11:00 PM	30 minutes, plus 15 minutes of rest	Peak service, events, closing and cleaning
Management and office team	10:00 AM to 6:00 PM	60 minutes	Administration, sales, marketing, finance, IT

Employees work six days a week with one rotating weekly day off, set by the Operations Officer and published a week in advance. Management may change shifts for events or busy periods with at least 24 hours' notice.

3.2 Attendance and punctuality

- Staff must record arrival and departure every day in the Attendance Register (MEZ-FRM-001) or the attendance system, in person and not for a colleague.
- Employees should be at their station, in uniform and ready, at the start of their shift.

- A grace period of 10 minutes is allowed. Arriving later counts as late. Three late arrivals in a calendar month lead to a documented conversation with the Supervisor. Further repeated lateness is handled under Section 7.
- If an employee will be late or absent, she must inform the Supervisor by phone or message at least 2 hours before her shift, except in an emergency.
- Absence for three or more consecutive working days without informing the company is treated as misconduct.
- Leaving early requires the Supervisor's approval and an entry in the register.
- Overtime must be approved in advance by the Operations Officer and is paid or compensated as set out in the HR Policy.

3.3 Leave procedures

The entitlements below are assumptions for the project and must be checked against applicable law.

Leave type	Yearly entitlement	Notice and proof	Approval
Annual leave	14 working days	At least 7 days' notice	Up to 2 days: Supervisor. 3 to 5 days: department manager. More than 5 days: CEO.
Casual leave	8 days	Same day, informed before the shift	Supervisor
Sick leave	8 days	Inform before the shift. Medical certificate if more than 2 days	Supervisor. HR Manager is informed.
Maternity and paternity leave	As required by applicable law	As early as possible, with a medical note where needed	HR Manager and CEO
Emergency or compassionate leave	Case by case	As soon as possible	CEO on HR Manager's advice
Unpaid leave	As agreed	At least 14 days' notice	CEO

Leave request steps

1. The employee completes the Leave Request Form (MEZ-FRM-002) and submits it to her approver.
2. The approver checks the roster and replies within 1 working day. Where staffing is too low, she proposes other dates.
3. The approver signs the form and passes a copy to the HR / Sales / Marketing Manager, who updates the leave record.
4. Leave is not taken until it has been approved. Unapproved absence is treated under Section 3.2.

4. Dress Code, Workplace Behaviour and Cleanliness

4.1 Dress code and personal hygiene

- Frontline staff wear the company uniform: a sage green apron over a plain cream or black top, and closed, non-slip shoes.

- Clothing must be modest, clean, ironed and professional. Management and office staff dress in smart, modest clothes.
- Staff wear their ID badge visibly during working hours.
- In food areas: hair is tied back or covered, nails are short and clean, hands are washed before starting and after any break, and loose jewellery is not worn.
- Staff who are unwell with symptoms that could affect food safety, such as vomiting, diarrhoea or a contagious infection, must inform the Supervisor and do not handle food.

4.2 Workplace behaviour

- Treat colleagues, guests, vendors and visitors with courtesy and respect at all times.
- Discrimination, harassment, bullying, shouting, offensive language and gossip are not allowed. See the Professional Communication Ethics SOP (MEZ-SOP-003).
- Protect guest privacy. Staff must not take, post or share photos or videos of guests, and must not discuss guests' personal details outside work.
- Staff must not photograph the kitchen, store room, security systems or internal documents, or post about them, without approval from the CEO or Marketing Executive.
- Personal phone use is limited to breaks, except for work or emergencies. Phones stay out of food preparation areas.
- Staff must disclose any conflict of interest, for example a family relationship with a vendor, to their manager.
- Gifts from vendors or guests worth more than Rs. 2,000 must be reported to the HR Manager. Tips are shared according to the HR Policy.
- Smoking, vaping, alcohol and any illegal substance are not allowed on the premises.

4.3 Cleanliness and organisation

- Everyone keeps her own station clean and tidy, and cleans as she goes.
- The Supervisor checks opening and closing cleaning checklists every day and signs them. Detailed cleaning and food safety steps are in the Operations and Quality Control SOP.
- Spills, broken items and hazards are cleared or reported immediately.
- Food and drinks are eaten only in the staff area. Personal belongings are kept in lockers, not on work surfaces.
- The reading corner, guest seating and washrooms are checked at least every 2 hours and cleaned as needed.

4.4 Meeting protocols

Meeting	When	Length	Who and purpose
Shift briefing	Start of each shift	10 minutes	Supervisor and shift team. Tasks, bookings, events, specials and safety reminders.
Weekly management meeting	Tuesday, 3:00 PM	60 minutes	All managers. Sales, operations, finance, issues, next week's events.
Monthly review	First week of the month	90 minutes	All 11 team members. Results against targets, policy and compliance review.

Meeting	When	Length	Who and purpose
One-to-one check-in	Monthly	20 minutes	Employee and manager. Feedback, support and training needs.

Meeting rules

- The organiser shares the agenda at least 24 hours before any meeting longer than 15 minutes.
- Meetings begin and end on time. Phones are on silent and not used during meetings.
- One person speaks at a time. Everyone can share her views and respectful disagreement is welcome.
- Minutes record decisions, owners and deadlines, and are shared within 24 hours using the Meeting Minutes Template. Actions are reviewed at the next meeting.

5. Use of Office Equipment, Resources and Shared Spaces

5.1 Equipment and resources

- Equipment, such as the espresso machine, grinders, ovens, refrigerators, POS terminal, tablets, laptops and phones, is for company business only.
- Staff use equipment only after they have been trained, and follow the manufacturer's and Operations SOP instructions.
- The IT Manager records issued devices against the employee's name. Staff are responsible for what they are issued and must not lend, move or take it off premises without approval.
- Faults, damage and unsafe equipment must be reported to the Supervisor immediately. Faulty equipment is tagged "Out of order" and not used.
- Staff must not use company equipment, internet, printing or supplies for personal business. Short personal use of WiFi on breaks is permitted within the IT Policy.
- Use resources responsibly. Switch off lights, air conditioning and equipment when not in use. Follow the stock-use rules to reduce waste.
- Loss or damage caused by negligence or misuse may be dealt with under Section 7.

5.2 Shared spaces

Space	Rules
Guest seating and cafe floor	Kept clean and welcoming. Tables are cleared and reset promptly. Staff do not sit in guest areas during service.
Reading and work corner	Books are returned to the shelves. Reserved desks are for Work & Sip members. Noise is kept low. Staff help guests with WiFi and sockets.
Events and workshop area	Booked through the Marketing Executive, set up before the event and reset and cleaned afterwards.
Prayer area	Kept clean, quiet and respectful. No cameras and no photography. Available to staff and guests at any time.
Staff room and lockers	Used for breaks and belongings only. Lockers are kept clean, and the cafe is not responsible for valuables left unlocked.
Kitchen and store room	Authorised staff only. Food hygiene, storage and first-in-first-out rules apply.

Space	Rules
Washrooms	Cleaned and restocked on a schedule, with a log kept on the door. No cameras are installed.

6. Employee Responsibilities, Reporting Lines and Escalation

6.1 General employee responsibilities

- Do your work carefully, honestly and to the standard in your job description.
- Follow lawful and reasonable instructions from your manager, and raise concerns respectfully.
- Protect company property, guest data and confidential information.
- Report safety hazards, incidents, complaints and policy breaches without delay.
- Attend meetings and training, and keep your own records, such as timesheets and forms, accurate.

6.2 Reporting lines

Position	Reports to
Owner	Not applicable (head of the business)
CEO	Owner
HR / Sales / Marketing Manager	CEO
Finance Director	CEO
Operations Officer	CEO
IT Manager	CEO
Security Manager	CEO
Documentation & Compliance Coordinator	CEO
Sales Executive	HR / Sales / Marketing Manager
Marketing Executive	HR / Sales / Marketing Manager
Supervisor	Operations Officer
Frontline service staff (baristas, kitchen, floor team)	Supervisor

The full organisational chart and job descriptions are in Deliverable 12 and must match this table.

6.3 Escalation procedure

Raise a problem with the lowest level that can solve it. If it is unresolved or too serious, escalate to the next level.

Level	Escalate to	Response time	Examples
1	Supervisor, or direct manager	Same shift or same day	Shift issues, equipment faults, minor disagreements

Level	Escalate to	Response time	Examples
2	Operations Officer or department manager	Within 1 working day	Unresolved shift problems, leave conflicts, repeated lateness
3	CEO	Within 2 working days	Serious conduct issues, disputes between managers, policy exceptions
4	Owner	Within 5 working days	Final appeals, matters involving the CEO

Direct reporting: Complaints of harassment, discrimination, safety risks or fraud may go straight to the HR / Sales / Marketing Manager, the CEO or the Owner without following the levels above. If the complaint is about one of these people, the employee goes to the next person above. Nobody will be penalised for reporting a concern in good faith.

Emergencies: Medical, fire or security emergencies follow the Security Measures SOP (MEZ-SOP-002) first and are reported to the Security Manager and CEO immediately.

7. Disciplinary Process

7.1 Principles

Discipline is meant to correct behaviour and protect the team and guests. It is applied fairly, consistently and in a way that is proportionate. The employee is told what the concern is, has the chance to respond, and a written record is kept.

7.2 Types of misconduct

Category	Examples	Usual action
Minor	Repeated lateness, dress code or cleanliness lapses, minor misuse of phone, untidy station	Verbal warning, coaching
Major	Unapproved absence, insubordination, negligence causing guest complaint or hygiene breach, misuse of equipment, breach of communication rules, ignoring safety rules	Written warning, final written warning or suspension
Gross	Harassment or abuse, theft or fraud, deliberate breach of guest privacy or photographing guests without consent, violence, falsifying records, working under the influence of alcohol or drugs	Suspension and investigation, then dismissal if proven

Serious cases may move directly to suspension or dismissal even if no earlier warnings were given.

7.3 Steps

1. **Report.** The concern is reported to the Supervisor, manager or HR Manager, and a short written note is made.
2. **Fact-finding.** The HR / Sales / Marketing Manager gathers facts within 3 working days. The employee may be suspended with pay during an investigation of a gross misconduct case.
3. **Notice and response.** The employee receives a written statement of the allegation and a meeting at which she can respond. She may bring a colleague for support.

4. **Decision.** Minor matters are decided by the Supervisor or department manager. Major and gross matters are decided by the HR Manager and the CEO. The decision and reasons are given in writing.
5. **Appeal.** The employee may appeal within 5 working days to the next senior level, and to the Owner if the CEO decided. The appeal decision is final.
6. **Record.** Warnings and outcomes are kept confidentially in the employee's file and treated under the HR Policy. Verbal and written warnings lapse after 12 months of good conduct.

7.4 Progressive actions

Where suitable, the sequence is: verbal warning, first written warning, final written warning, suspension or demotion, termination. Disciplinary action is separate from any legal action the company may take for criminal acts.

8. Policy Review, Approval and Compliance

8.1 Review and approval process

- This SOP is reviewed at least once every 12 months, and sooner after a serious incident, legal change or major change in the business.
- Anyone may suggest a change by sending a written request to the Documentation & Compliance Coordinator, who logs it in the Master Document Register.
- The Coordinator drafts the update. The HR / Sales / Marketing Manager and affected department heads review it.
- The CEO approves minor changes. Major changes also need the Owner's approval.
- Approved changes get a new version number (1.1, 1.2 for minor edits and 2.0 for major revisions). Old versions are archived.
- All staff are told of changes and sign an acknowledgement of the current version. New employees sign during onboarding.

8.2 Compliance

The Supervisor and department managers check day-to-day compliance. The Documentation & Compliance Coordinator carries out a quarterly spot check, reports to the CEO, and tracks corrective actions until they are closed. Breaches may lead to action under Section 7.

8.3 Revision history

Version	Date	Description	Author
1.0	01 Nov 2026	First issue	Documentation & Compliance Coordinator

8.4 Approval

	Name and position	Signature	Date
Prepared by	[Name], Documentation & Compliance Coordinator		
Reviewed by	[Name], HR / Sales / Marketing Manager		

	Name and position	Signature	Date
Approved by	[Name], CEO		
Approved by	[Name], Owner		

8.5 Employee acknowledgement

I have read and understood the General Office SOP (MEZ-SOP-001, Version 1.0) and agree to follow it.

Employee name	Position	Signature	Date